

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET D — ASSERTION & REASONING SPECIAL****CHAPTER 01: UNDERSTANDING SOCIAL SCIENCE****TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES****MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS****SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-D-01****Student's Name:** _____**Roll No.:** _____**Class & Section:** Class IX - _____**Date of Exam:** _____**Invigilator's Sign:** _____**General Instructions (SET D - Assertion & Reasoning Special):**

1. The question paper comprises **25 Assertion-Reasoning Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Each question consists of two statements — **Assertion (A)** and **Reason (R)**.
3. Select the correct option from the following 4 standardized choices:
 - **(A)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 - **(B)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
 - **(C)** Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
 - **(D)** Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.
4. **Section A (Q1 – Q10):** Core Concepts & Theoretical Principles.
5. **Section B (Q11 – Q18):** Evidentiary Proofs, Case Inferences & Historical/Geographical Mechanisms.
6. **Section C (Q19 – Q25):** Advanced Conceptual Nuances & Institutional/Analytical Complexities.
7. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
8. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

STANDARD DIRECTIONS FOR ALL 25 ASSERTION & REASONING QUESTIONS:

- (A)** Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(B) Both (A) and (R) are true but (R) is NOT the correct explanation of (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false.
(D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

SECTION A: CORE THEORETICAL PRINCIPLES (Q.1 TO Q.10) [10 MARKS]**Q.1**

Assertion (A): Social science employs systematic empirical observation and critical inquiry rather than mere conjecture.

Reason (R): Social scientific hypotheses must be verifiable against documentary records, material artifacts, and statistical data.

- (A)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). **(B)** Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. **(D)** Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.2

Assertion (A): Inscriptions engraved on stone pillars and copper plates are classified as primary historical sources.

Reason (R): Primary historical sources are contemporary records created during the exact period of the historical event being investigated.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.3

Assertion (A): Historians rely entirely on official royal court chronicles to reconstruct an objective history of ancient societies.

Reason (R): Court chroniclers were commissioned by ruling monarchs and frequently exaggerated imperial triumphs while omitting royal defeats.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.4

Assertion (A): Coins (numismatics) serve as vital evidence for delineating the geographic territorial extent of ancient kingdoms.

Reason (R): The widespread archaeological discovery of uniform royal coinage across distinct regions reflects active economic circulation and political hegemony.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.5

Assertion (A): Radiocarbon dating (Carbon-14) can be utilized to determine the age of ancient bronze statues and gold ornaments.

Reason (R): Carbon-14 dating measures the radioactive decay of carbon isotopes present exclusively in organic materials that once absorbed atmospheric carbon.

- (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A).
(C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true.

Q.6

Assertion (A): The Law of Superposition in archaeological stratigraphy states that lower undisturbed sedimentary strata are older than upper strata.

Reason (R): Natural sedimentary deposition accumulates sequentially over time, laying newer debris over preexisting cultural layers.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.7

Assertion (A): Foreign travellers' accounts, such as those of Megasthenes and Xuanzang, provide completely unbiased objective accounts of ancient India.

Reason (R): Foreign travellers were outsiders unencumbered by local royal patronage or caste affiliations.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.8

Assertion (A): Epigraphy is the scientific study and decipherment of inscriptions engraved on hard surfaces.

Reason (R): Palaeography examines the historical evolution of handwriting, script forms, and alphabets over successive centuries.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.9

Assertion (A): Dendrochronology establishes absolute calendar dates for wooden architectural beams found at archaeological sites.

Reason (R): Trees generate distinct annual growth rings whose width varies systematically with seasonal climatic fluctuations.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.10

Assertion (A): Social science disciplines such as economics, sociology, and political science are studied in complete isolation from one another.

Reason (R): Human societal behavior operates as an interconnected whole where economic policies, political governance, and social norms continuously interact.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

SECTION B: EVIDENTIARY PROOFS & MECHANISMS (Q.11 TO Q.18) [8 MARKS]**Q.11**

Assertion (A): Archaeological excavations employ the Wheeler box-grid method to preserve stratigraphic balks between excavated trenches.

Reason (R): Stratigraphic balks preserve vertical soil profiles that allow archaeologists to correlate layers across adjacent excavation pits.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.12

Assertion (A): A high correlation between two social variables always proves a direct cause-and-effect relationship.

Reason (R): Correlation merely signifies that two variables change simultaneously, which may be caused by an underlying third lurking variable.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.13

Assertion (A): Secondary sources are written after historical events by researchers interpreting and synthesizing primary evidence.

Reason (R): A modern textbook on Harappan urbanism written by an archaeologist is an example of a secondary source.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.14

Assertion (A): The study of place names (toponymy) can provide clues about ancient settlement patterns, linguistics, and environment.

Reason (R): Settlement names often preserve archaic vocabulary describing local geomorphic features, flora, or founding dynasties long after languages evolve.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.15

Assertion (A): Quantitative sample surveys completely eliminate all forms of research error in social scientific studies.

Reason (R): Sample surveys may suffer from sampling bias, non-response error, and poorly phrased interview questions.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.16

Assertion (A): Oral traditions and folklore are discarded by modern historians as having zero historiographical value.

Reason (R): Oral traditions can preserve authentic community memories and migration narratives when critically corroborated with archaeological evidence.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.17

Assertion (A): Cartography plays an indispensable role in geographic and historical social science analysis.

Reason (R): Spatial distribution maps allow researchers to visualize trade corridors, resource concentrations, and demographic shifts.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.18

Assertion (A): Microscopic analysis of pollen grains (palynology) allows researchers to reconstruct ancient environmental vegetation and agricultural history.

Reason (R): Pollen grains possess durable outer walls of sporopollenin that resist decay in waterlogged archaeological sediments.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

SECTION C: ADVANCED NUANCES & INSTITUTIONAL COMPLEXITIES (Q.19 TO Q.25) [7 MARKS]**Q.19**

Assertion (A): Scientific neutrality requires social scientists to abandon all ethical commitments to democratic constitutional values.

Reason (R): Objective scientific methodology requires factual honesty in data analysis, while social science education fosters informed, ethical citizenship.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.20

Assertion (A): Historiographical revisionism is a legitimate feature of academic historical research.

Reason (R): The discovery of unexamined primary archival documents and advanced archaeological techniques can modify existing historical interpretations.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.21

Assertion (A): Karl Popper proposed that a scientific hypothesis must be capable of empirical falsification.

Reason (R): A hypothesis that cannot be tested or proven false by any conceivable empirical observation is dogmatic rather than scientific.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.22

Assertion (A): Archaeological artifacts found in surface scatter are more chronologically reliable than artifacts sealed in stratified contexts.

Reason (R): Surface artifacts have been subjected to agricultural ploughing, weathering, and human displacement, destroying stratigraphic provenance.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.23

Assertion (A): Social scientists utilize triangulation by cross-checking multiple independent sources of data.

Reason (R): Relying on a single data source increases vulnerability to individual author bias, translation errors, and localized anomalies.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.24

Assertion (A): Ethnocentrism in social science research refers to the practice of evaluating other cultures strictly according to the standards of one's own culture.

Reason (R): Ethnocentric perspectives promote objective, universally valid cross-cultural generalizations.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

Q.25

Assertion (A): Social science inquiry helps citizens identify misinformation and develop critical thinking in a constitutional democracy.

Reason (R): Democratic governance relies on informed citizens capable of analyzing government policies, socioeconomic disparities, and civil liberties.

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| (A) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true and Reason (R) is the correct explanation of Assertion (A). | (B) Both Assertion (A) and Reason (R) are true but Reason (R) is NOT the correct explanation of Assertion (A). |
| (C) Assertion (A) is true but Reason (R) is false. | (D) Assertion (A) is false but Reason (R) is true. |

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET D)

01 (A) (B) (C) (D)

02 (A) (B) (C) (D)

03 (A) (B) (C) (D)

04 (A) (B) (C) (D)

05 (A) (B) (C) (D)

06 (A) (B) (C) (D)

07 (A) (B) (C) (D)

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11 (A) (B) (C) (D)

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13 (A) (B) (C) (D)

14 (A) (B) (C) (D)

15 (A) (B) (C) (D)

16 (A) (B) (C) (D)

17 (A) (B) (C) (D)

18 (A) (B) (C) (D)

19 (A) (B) (C) (D)

20 (A) (B) (C) (D)

21 (A) (B) (C) (D)

22 (A) (B) (C) (D)

23 (A) (B) (C) (D)

24 (A) (B) (C) (D)

25 (A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & HISTORICAL/GEOGRAPHICAL CAUSAL EXPLANATIONS (SET D)

Q. No.	Correct	Causal Rationale & Conceptual Explanation
Q.1	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and correctly explains why social science qualifies as a rigorous scientific discipline through empirical verifiability.
Q.2	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and provides the precise historiographical definition of why contemporary inscriptions are primary sources.
Q.3	(D)	Assertion is false: Historians do not rely solely on court chronicles because of their inherent royal bias. Reason is true: Court chroniclers were patronized by kings and produced partisan panegyrics.
Q.4	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the economic and political logic of how coin distribution maps sovereign territory.
Q.5	(D)	Assertion is false: Radiocarbon dating cannot date inorganic metallic artifacts like bronze or gold. Reason is true: C-14 decay operates strictly on organic materials like bone, wood, and charcoal.
Q.6	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the geological and physical mechanism governing archaeological stratigraphy.
Q.7	(D)	Assertion is false: Foreign accounts contain cultural misunderstandings, linguistic barriers, and personal biases (e.g., Megasthenes claiming India had no slaves). Reason is partly true in isolation but false in assuming total objectivity.
Q.8	(B)	Both statements are correct definitions, but Reason defines palaeography and does not explain why or how epigraphy is conducted.
Q.9	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and provides the biological and climatic basis of tree-ring chronometric dating.
Q.10	(D)	Assertion is false: Social sciences are highly interdisciplinary. Reason is true: Human behavior spans multiple interacting societal dimensions.
Q.11	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains Sir Mortimer Wheeler's methodology for maintaining horizontal and vertical stratigraphic control.
Q.12	(D)	Assertion is false: Correlation does not imply causation. Reason is true: Simultaneous statistical variation can be coincidental or driven by confounding variables.
Q.13	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and provides an accurate, illustrative example of a secondary historical synthesis.
Q.14	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains how linguistic persistence in place names preserves historical geomorphic and cultural data.
Q.15	(D)	Assertion is false: Surveys cannot eliminate all errors. Reason is true: Surveys are vulnerable to structural sampling errors and response biases.
Q.16	(D)	Assertion is false: Historians use oral histories with critical triangulation. Reason is true: Oral traditions offer valuable cultural insights when verified.
Q.17	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the analytical power of spatial mapping in social science.
Q.18	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains the biochemical durability that makes fossil pollen reliable environmental evidence.
Q.19	(D)	Assertion is false: Scientific objectivity does not mean abandoning constitutional ethics. Reason is true: Empirical rigor coexists with democratic values.

Q. No.	Correct	Causal Rationale & Conceptual Explanation
Q.20	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains why historical knowledge evolves as new empirical evidence emerges.
Q.21	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and explains Popper's demarcation criterion between empirical science and dogma.
Q.22	(D)	Assertion is false: Surface scatter is far less reliable than sealed strata. Reason is true: Surface disturbance disrupts cultural stratigraphy.
Q.23	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and correctly explains why methodological triangulation enhances research validity.
Q.24	(C)	Assertion is true: Ethnocentrism judges other cultures by one's own standards. Reason is false: Ethnocentrism introduces severe bias, not objective generalization.
Q.25	(A)	Assertion is true. Reason is true and directly explains the essential role of social science education in nurturing active democratic citizenship.